CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

Core Item Update: Men's kurtas and sets 2026–28

Menswear is quieter and more versatile.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



Overview

Menswear is quieter and more versatile. The straight band-collar kurta is a stable classic, linen sets and pathani suits are rising, and short and asymmetric kurtas carry the fusion energy. Embroidery moves to the neckline and cuffs.

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INVEST	TEST	MAINTAIN	REDUCE

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

The details

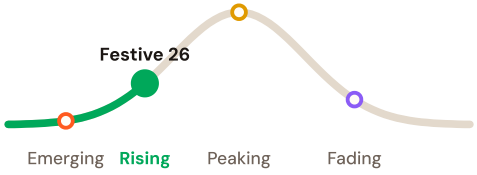
Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

Linen kurta sets

Breathable linen and cotton-silk for relaxed celebrations. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



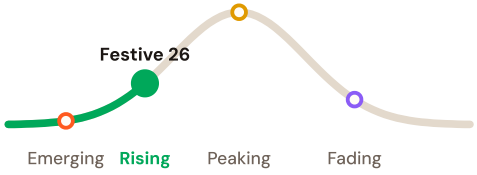
Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Fading	



INVEST RISING

Short kurtas with jeans

Hip-length kurtas worn with denim for everyday wear. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



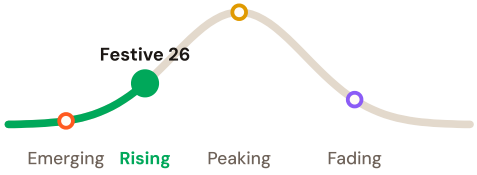
Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Rising	Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Fading	



INVEST RISING

Asymmetric-hem kurtas

Angled or layered hems for a modern kurta. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



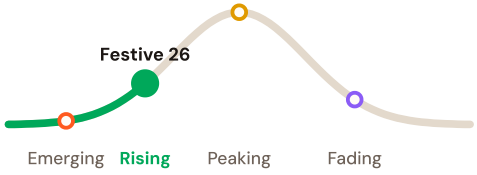
Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Rising	Festive 27 Peaking
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INVEST RISING

Pathani suits

Collared Pathani kurtas with salwar, in solid tones. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



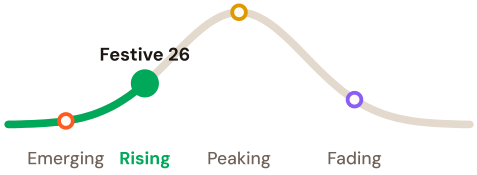
Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking
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INVEST RISING

Neckline and cuff embroidery

Subtle embroidery placed only at the neckline and cuffs. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking | Summer 28 | Festive 28

INVEST RISING

Burgundy velvet kurtas

Dark burgundy velvet kurtas worn with black trousers, as on Vicky Kaushal at Manish Malhotra's Diwali party, Mumbai, Nov 2026, with burgundy velvet co-ords on women the same night. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



TEST EMERGING

Floral kurtas with harem trousers

Deep-toned floral-print kurtas paired with relaxed harem trousers instead of churidars, as worn by Aamir Khan in Mumbai, 29 Oct 2026; a softer, comfortable festive set for men. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



MAINTAIN PEAKING

Straight kurta with band collar

Straight kurtas with a Nehru (band) collar and churidar or straight trousers. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.



Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking

Peaking

Fading

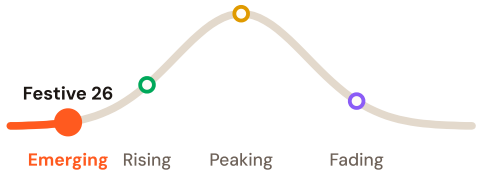
Festive 26
Rising

Summer 27
Peaking

Festive 27
Rising

Summer 28
Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Festive 26
Emerging

Summer 27
Rising

Festive 27
Rising

Summer 28
Peaking

Festive 28
Fading

Summer 28
Peaking

Festive 28
Peaking

How to update your men's kurtas and sets range

- Keep the straight band-collar kurta in calm handloom colours.
- Invest in linen kurta sets for summer weddings.
- Add short kurtas styled with denim for younger customers.
- Move embroidery to neckline and cuffs, tone-on-tone.

What to check in men's kurtas and sets development

- **Length:** short and mid-thigh for casual, knee length for occasions.
- **Collar:** mandarin, band and Nehru collars lead.
- **Fit:** straight cuts with comfortable ease; avoid tight sleeves.
- **Sets:** state whether the pyjama or trouser and jacket are included.

Fabric guide

Choose fabric by occasion, climate and price point. The same design often needs two fabric options: a premium version and a value or summer version.

- Cotton and linen for summer and daily wear
- Silk blends for festive
- Chikankari and tonal embroidery on cotton
- Jacquards for occasion sets

The global view

Indian men's kurtas and sets sell well beyond India, to South Asian communities in the UK, North America, the Gulf, Southeast Asia and Australia, and increasingly to customers discovering Indian craft. For international customers, provide clear size conversions, care guidance and styling ideas for local events.

Common questions

Which colours are strongest for men's festive wear? Ivory, pastels and deeper jewel tones, depending on the event and time of day.

Do men buy kurta sets online? Yes, especially with clear size charts and photos on models of different builds.

See every men's kurtas and sets detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–28.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).